



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Do you believe in destiny?



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How superstitious are you?
- What do you do if you are in a situation that could be bad luck?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about friendship, relationships, feelings and reactions.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations in the past.
- I can tell stories and anecdotes.





Let's Explore!

The rest is history*!

* We say that "*the rest is history*" when the events are well-known or are obvious, so they don't need to be repeated.

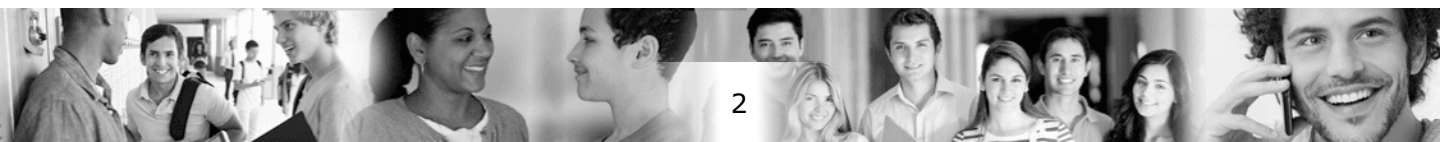


Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Leo has always been superstitious. He's been carrying a rabbit's foot his whole life! He believes all the old wives' tales he's ever heard. When I asked him why he said, "Why take chances? People have believed these things for many generations. I have always felt that it was better to be safe than sorry when it came to that sort of thing."

One day Leo was walking down a quiet street. Suddenly he saw a black cat. He immediately turned the corner and stepped into a narrow alley, safely avoiding the black cat. He did not realize at first that something was happening in the alley. A young woman was on a ladder. She was climbing up the ladder to get in through a window about three floors up. When Leo turned into the alley, he was heading under the ladder at full speed! He saw another black cat and froze. That's when he noticed the ladder was standing there.

If he hadn't seen the cat, things might have ended differently! If he hadn't noticed the ladder, he wouldn't have looked up. If he hadn't looked up he wouldn't have noticed the young woman, who we all know as Tanya now, losing her balance. If he hadn't thought quickly, she could have been badly injured. If Tom hadn't broken Tanya's fall, they never would have met. The two of them ended up in a heap on the ground. They dusted themselves off, laughed, and went out for lunch. The rest, as they say, is history!





Let's Practice!

What would happen if Leo hadn't seen the black cat?

Instruction: Match the two parts of the sentences from Column A to Column B.

COLUMN A

1. If he hadn't seen the cat,
2. If he hadn't noticed the ladder,
3. If he hadn't looked up he wouldn't have noticed the young woman,
4. If he hadn't thought quickly,
5. If Tom hadn't broken Tanya's fall,

COLUMN B

- a. he wouldn't have looked up.
- b. she could have been badly injured.
- c. they never would have met.
- d. things might have ended differently!
- e. who we all know as Tanya now, losing her balance.



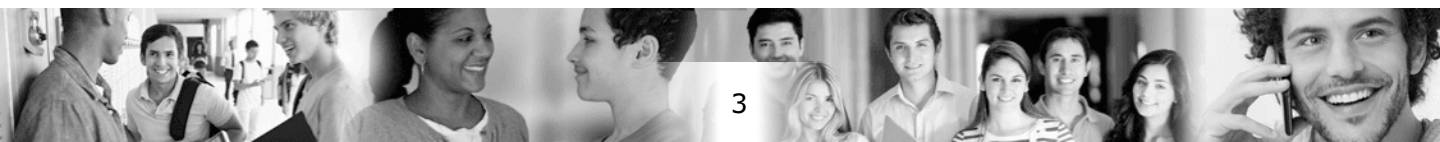
Let's Practice!

Leo tells us his anecdote.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write 1, 2 or 3, taking into account the information below. There is an example for you to follow. Example: Leo has always been superstitious.

1. Action that started in the past and still has a connection with the present.
2. Action that started and finished in the past.
3. Action that took place in the past and makes an emphasis on duration.

- a. One day Leo was walking down a quiet street. ____
- b. Suddenly he saw a black cat. ____
- c. He immediately turned the corner and stepped into a narrow alley. ____
- d. Something strange was happening in the alley. ____
- e. People have believed these things for many generations. ____





Extension Activity

Discuss situations that relate to superstitions.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of superstitions or old wives' tales that you, friends, or other people in your family think about when you do things.
- Write down the superstitions and say what the people do. (*When I spill the salt, I throw some over my left shoulder.*) Try for 8 of them.
- Now recount the superstition and what the person does by using hypothetical statements. (*If I had spilled the salt, I would have ...*)
- Share your statements with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write down superstitions and what people do because of them.

☐
☐

I use the third conditional to recount what people would do hypothetically.

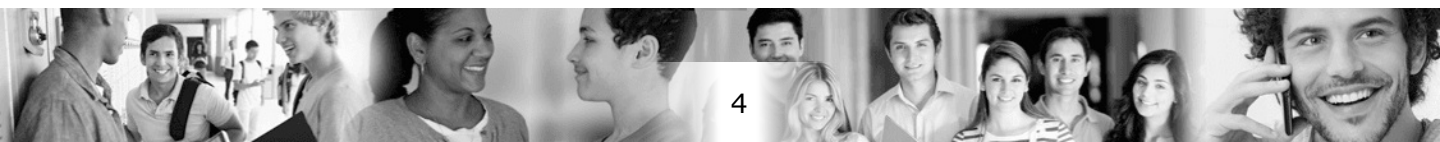
☐
☐

I share my hypothetical statements with a partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **superstitious** (adjective): having beliefs rooted in magic rather than human logic or science
e.g. Leo has always been superstitious.
- **narrow** (adjective): not wide; a short distance from one side to the other
e.g. He turned the corner and stepped into a narrow alley.
- **alley** (noun): a narrow street between buildings
e.g. He stepped into a narrow alley, safely avoiding the black cat.
- **to realize** (verb): to notice or understand something that you didn't know before
e.g. He did not realize at first that something was happening in the alley.
- **old wives' tale** (expression): advice believed correct in the past but now known to be wrong
e.g. He believes all the old wives' tales he hears.





Learning Points

Talking About the Past: The Simple Past, The Present Perfect and the Past Continuous Tenses

When you tell stories and anecdotes, it is common to use a mixture of tenses. This allows you to convey a variety of timelines and action sequences.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

For example:

*Suddenly he **saw** a black cat.*

*He immediately **turned** the corner and **stepped** into a narrow alley.*

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way. It is common to use *for* and *since* when referring to time periods in the Present Perfect.

For example:

*Leo **has always been** superstitious. People **have believed** these things **for** many generations.*

You use the Past Continuous tense to talk about an action that was happening at a time before now and to describe the background in a story written in the past tense.

For example:

*When Leo turned into the alley, he **was heading** under the ladder at full speed! That's when he noticed the ladder **was standing** there.*





Learning Points

The Third Conditional - Talking Hypothetically About the Past

You use the third conditional to talk about situations that could have happened in the past, but did not.

You often use the third conditional to speculate about how past events could have been different.

When you want to talk about situations in the past in a hypothetical context (not real or necessarily true), you use the structures *could/would have + past participle*.

*If Tom **hadn't broken** Tanya's fall, they never **would have met**.*

Look at the chart below for the structure of the third conditional:

Conditional Name	Structure	Example
Third	<i>If + Past Perfect, would have + past participle</i>	<i>If he hadn't noticed the ladder, he wouldn't have looked up.</i>

Examples:

- *If he **hadn't looked up** he **wouldn't have noticed** the young woman, who we all know as Tanya now, losing her balance.*
- *If he **hadn't thought quickly**, she **could have been** badly injured.*

